

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Obedience

Discipline as authority, obedience, rules, enforcement, reliability, trust, and the risk of the piaw–piaw soldier.

O1

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

You are in the space and based on how the army is set up, you have to do whatever you are sent here to do, the obedience to listen when you are spoken to, and to follow instructions without question. But I can say for the majority (of recruits), they are not used to being unquestionably obedient. And it takes them a while to adjust to that type of discipline.

O2

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Perhaps the most governed individuals inna Jamaica by the amount o' rules.

O3

Chaz Stonegrill (interview, school leader)

Not a written rule, but becomes clear when someone fails to meet it.

O4

Ramon Brown (interview, instructor)

Rank carries a certain level of authority that is assumed, yet higher authority can undermine it. If this person does nothing, disrespect can spread like wildfire.

O5

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

I was speaking to some mothers from [name of community redacted] who were asking me about their sons joining the JDF (Jamaican military) to learn some discipline. I said to them, discipline is not really taught in the JDF. Discipline is enforced. It's in the enforcing or in the enforcement of discipline that people start learning and understanding that this place requires you to be disciplined. And if yuh slip up, yuh get mash up (get punished / dealt with harshly).

O6

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

Yuh can't put nuh piaw–piaw soldier to go do [that] dem ha'll be well disciplined.

O7

Jonathan McDermott (focus group, school leader)

Discipline need, um, a structure; and that is why the army is designed the way it is.

O1

Nkrumah Maroon (focus group, instructor)

Discipline for me is, I use the universal definition, which is training someone to obey by using punishment.

O2

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

I think discipline was derived from authority.

O3

Bob Wellington (interview, school leader)

Do's and Don'ts are mainly briefed and are not always kept in hand for re-reading.

O4

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

If the instructor said jump, I would want to know how high, how long, and just jump. I believe that if the persons who are set above me have intent to make me better, then what they're instilling in me should be to make me better.

O5

Ramon Brown (interview, instructor)

You treat your authority like it's a garden to be nurtured. You tactically do things to ensure that it stays with you. You have to find creative ways of ensuring that at all times discipline is maintained.

O6

Ramon Brown (focus group, instructor)

Discipline can also speak to you as the enforcer, requiring you conforming and not just you teaching someone to conform.

O7

Marley Thunder (focus group, instructor)

When e discipline bruk dung now e damage e trust weh dem have fi wi.

O8

Kevin Jewinsky (interview, school leader)

Ah jus' so di Army ting set.

O9

Lee Brown (interview, school leader)

We would have the worst army in the world right now.

O1

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

My construct of discipline at the time was just to follow instructions, to follow orders.

O2

Kwame Dawn (focus group, instructor)

If e discipline bruk dung, higher authority can bring it back.

O3

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

The Green Book.

O4

Passion Purpose (interview, school leader)

It is something not necessarily have to be written, there can be unwritten rules. If we were to write everything, then we would have a problem.

O5

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

It's not a rank that makes a person. A person makes rank.

O6

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

Dem ha'll show wi that level of trust, just the same.

O7

Chaz Stonegrill (interview, school leader)

In order for them to trust in what we do, we have to be viewed as professionals with the discipline.

O8

Kevin Jewinsky (interview, school leader)

Even small lapse can throw off the whole thing.

O9

Kwame Dawn (interview, instructor)

Oi army don't work so.

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Internalisation

Discipline as innate, ingrained, repeated, self-regulated, morally unstable, widened, and context-dependent.

i1

Dwayne Andrews (focus group, school leader)

In its raw form it is not codified. It is innate. It is natural. A baby just born, a blank slate. The first thing the baby does is cry. And the next thing, him probably ah move towards ah di breast. So is a survival. How him know say fi move to di breast? Because there are certain stimuli that are there that are innate. Certain things are within us, like our five senses. There are several others that we are blinded about. It is a built-in.

i2

Marcus Black (interview, school leader)

We are creatures of habits. Drill being repetitive in nature will cause us to automatically change. Over time, it becomes almost ingrained. Developing brain memory and muscle memory.

i3

Anara Birdsong (focus group, school leader)

Yuh know how much things recruits think but they don't act? Dem jus' roll ... crawl ... and conform.

i4

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

So discipline ah di ability fi behave in a controlled environment. Self-discipline wudda refer more to yourself. You are the environment. Your rules. Your principles.

i5

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

They're very disciplined for what they want: gang members, they come in, they conform. They're disciplined enough to conform to our system. To be the enemy within. For the purpose of intel gathering.

i6

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

There's discipline in every aspect of their everyday life. Discipline is wide.

i7

Lee Brown (interview, school leader)

Most of the times when I talk to them, it's mostly girlfriend, money problem, dem nuh have nuh money discipline. My money problem was me spending my money foolishly – giving females, three or four females mi ah date, forget about myself, 'cause mi think ah love. When I reached up, get [rank redacted], I start to discipline myself. Mi seh to dem, 'if you ask mi for a money mi give you 5, accept it. Mi assist you. Have a money discipline. Fix yourself.

i8

Chaz Stonegrill (interview, school leader)

I believe that it stems initially, originally from the home – that first socialisation. Your values. I believe those are also hard to change. So if we don't catch these things in the bud, it might be difficult to correct their way of thinking, because it's associated with their beliefs – and beliefs are difficult to change.

i1

Anara Birdsong (focus group, school leader)

Not to cut you, but I would tend to disagree with the idea that it is innate. It is all depending on the condition in which he or she has been brought up: culture, atmosphere, community. So yes, we can get somebody who is zero discipline here; to what we expect as military beings. But it is not that they have zero. It is just that what they have been exposed to.

i2

Anaya Redemption (interview, school leader)

There's always a goal. I want to lose 10 pounds. I have to do my diet and start doing exercise. I need to exercise three times daily. I might not like to exercise, but the goal is to lose 10 pounds. So, I persist, even though I don't want to. If it is ambiguous, it's not a goal. It's just I want to try that.

i3

Anara Birdsong (focus group, school leader)

I will add that fear of punishment, however, and do this, you will be able to achieve this: 'Pass out' [graduate]. 'Turn (become) a soldier'.

i4

Unspecified participant judgement (reported judgement, participant)

Him never have deh self-control deh.

i5

Marco Wolf (interview, school leader)

When they come in the work, these are the same soldiers that will steal the pick-up, steal a rifle, or rounds. We try to sift these persons out within the training. MIU [military intelligence unit] might have missed these persons.

i6

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

My father started out by teaching us how to save, that you only needed just enough, there was no need to kind of take what is not yours. Discipline, now, is also about your resources and not wasting, not just turning up; it is in everything that you do.

i7

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

The persons who came here, you can tell the homes. They came with some level of discipline. The first thing I ask them: were you a cadet? You don't have to tell them to stand to attention, to say 'sir'. Very sharp. I personally think, with the small things: when you fulfil the small things, you can be depended on to fulfill the larger things.

i1

Kwame Dawn (interview, instructor)

Mi feel disrupt' because mi always wonder: how dem fi super indisciplined, as dem reach?

i2

Anthony Jackson (interview, instructor)

Now when yuh disciplined, yuh ah go put out wan 60% every day, every day, every day. And with that 60%, yuh develop consistency, and yuh start see progress. I think discipline is really just the ability to self-regulate.

i3

Passion Purpose (interview, school leader)

As a recruit, I didn't need my instructor to tell me to get my uniform ready. I didn't have to wait on a duty roster to know that the bathrooms are to wash.

i4

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

Discipline is not a feeling. Discipline nuh have time and place. Discipline is supposed to be ingrained in you, so even if you feel like not to, you're going to. It is you controlling yourself, no matter what, the time, the season. If this is what you should do, this is what you will do. It is not when you feel like; discipline is right through.

i5

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

They are disciplined enough to dot each 'I' and cross each 'I' to do the wrong, but they don't have the self-control to say no.

i6

Malayo Montanas (interview, instructor)

Discipline cover a variety of things. Discipline is good and discipline is bad. A 'gun man' [an armed criminal in Jamaican usage] can be one of the most disciplined people in terms of his self-control. Him master him craft.

i7

Anthony Jackson (interview, instructor)

One of the major things people want to free themselves from right now is poverty. If you disciplined with your financial spending, it ah go become easier to free yourself from poverty.

i8

Kevin Grant (interview, instructor)

Discipline in the home and discipline in the military are two different disciplines. Very different.

i9

Marco Wolf (interview, school leader)

I think it has to do with a lot of things. It's not a singular activity. Timeliness. Self-esteem. Community. Environment. Who they interact with on a daily basis. They can be disciplined in one aspect but indisciplined in a next, which would be an 'integrity' issue – because it is what they are doing when somebody else is watching.

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Performativity

Discipline as visible display, eye-service, Hummingbird, Jankro, standard, audience, and the test of no one looking.

P1

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Some will naturally be guided by their goals of wanting to become a soldier. They say, 'hey, mi nuh dig dis yeh into [I don't dig this], so mi ah go be ah' Hummingbird, while I'm here, fi get to weh mi want go, to get by.

P2

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

Sharp and hard.

P3

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

Mannerisms, display, etiquettes.

P4

Paris May (interview, school leader)

The person in charge of me doesn't even know what the standard is.

P5

Marco Wolf (interview, school leader)

Discipline goes hand in hand with positive or negative reinforcements. Rigid. Consequences.

P6

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

You can't be real disciplined if it's only when you're around me. It's probably eye-service, eye servant ting, because you see the crowd.

P7

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

Do you realise that everything you do is judged by your core values? Do you recognise that these are the things that write your military service? If you are not disciplined, you can't be honest because it takes discipline to be honest.

P8

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

In that absence, they fill it with something, the recruits.

P9

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

They have the JDF [Jamaican military] in particular as this high discipline institution and once they see a member, there's that high expectation of discipline and a certain mannerism that they expect and if they don't see that being portrayed it's as if they would be disappointed.

P1

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Yuh have di Hummingbird now, which wudda be e Jamaica national bird, which we wudda find with such quality and standard. And den now, e Jankro, weh nuh care, eat anything- see a rat deh, pick, pick him up and gone. Whilst e Hummingbird go him likkle flowers, give back to nature itself.

P2

James Bond (interview, school leader)

Dress and deportment, highest standard, a disciplined individual.

P3

Paris May (interview, school leader)

Discipline is a bit in the gray.

P4

Zion Bamboo (focus group, school leader)

The undisciplined disciplinarian looks disciplined when he's to lead but when he's to follow him gone rogue.

P5

Lee Brown (interview, school leader)

We just maintain the standard weh dem want.

P6

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

If it's a case where you only run when you have BFAST [fitness test] or PT [physical fitness training], you try and push out your all, because you see the crowd. Is it a case that we can say you're really disciplined though? Or you're just motivated? Because motivation is different from discipline.

P7

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Turn back into a Jankro. Di likkle Jankro mentality start to come out.

P8

Kevin Jewinsky (interview, school leader)

No, it's not about look good when the TO [training officer] comes. It has to be that into your sight too, it has to actually be good.

P1

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Recruit training is the most where discipline comes out, because this is the only part in Army career where you're under so much lock and key and guarded. You're being watched by so many, many persons. So automatically, a person can put up an image, a character, or persona, to fit in whilst he's here. And then when you leave here, turn back into a Jankro. Di likkle Jankro mentality start to come out.

P2

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

Neatness is often associated with discipline, and it works on the mind.

P3

Paris May (interview, school leader)

Leeway.

P4

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

If yuh slip up, yuh get mash up.

P5

Black Lion (interview, instructor)

People work with weh dem eyes see more than wah dem hear.

P6

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

When you leave here, in the wider force, he's not under much pressure as he would be here.

P7

Dwayne Andrews (focus group, school leader)

They think that discipline is the master of them all; yuh can't have Courage without it, yuh can't have Commitment. Honour. Integrity. Loyalty. The other character traits are there. They're all ingrained in the Discipline.

P8

Kwame Dawn (interview / focus group, instructor)

Discipline ah nuh jus' sup'n weh yuh talk bout. It all ah go boll down to, as we love to say in the military, doing the right thing even when no one is looking.